

JavaScript Number Datatype - Theory Notes

What is Number Datatype?

JavaScript has only one numeric datatype: number.

Unlike many languages, JavaScript does not separate int, float, or double.

Whole numbers and decimal numbers are all stored as number.

Types of Number Values

1. Integer Number: Whole numbers such as 100, 50, -20
2. Decimal Number: Numbers with decimal point such as 10.5, 99.99
3. Infinity: Result of dividing a positive number by zero ($1/0$)
4. -Infinity: Result of dividing a negative number by zero ($-1/0$)
5. NaN (Not a Number): Invalid numeric result such as "Hello"/123

Important Point

`typeof NaN` returns "number".

NaN is a special numeric value representing an invalid calculation result.

Summary

Integer -> number

Decimal -> number

Infinity -> number

-Infinity -> number

NaN -> number

Best Practice

Use `isNaN(value)` to check whether a value is an invalid number.